APPROVED ON MARCH 25,, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

Budget Workshop:
March 19, 2026
9:00 a.m. – Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron Smith, Colene Martin, and Gary Richardson and Kassie Austin as Recorder

The meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

1. Budget Workshop
Ruth Nelson, County Finance Director, presented the Budget Workshop PowerPoint (Exhibit 1) and reviewed the various rates over county departments. Facilities is operating the same rate as last year, keeping their rate status quo at $0.90 a square foot at operations, and $0.40 a square foot for depreciation. The ISF fund is projected at a 10% decrease. The insurance schedule is projected at a 13% increase based off the experiences. The leave liability is projected to increase from 2.5% to 3.5%.

The meeting was adjourned at 10:22 a.m.

Exhibit 1: PowerPoint Presentation

Budget workshop
March 19, 2026
Exhibit 1

Budget Workshop
FY 2026-27

March 19, 2026

JOSEPHINE COUNTY

Rate Setting

- Facilities: Same rate as last year
  - $0.90/sq ft Operating, $0.40/sq ft Depreciation
- Fleet: Schedule provided
- Internal Service Fund (ISF): 9.5%
  - Decreased from 10% due to increasing fund balance
  - No major changes to personnel or materials and services
- Insurance Schedule (Insurance Reserve Fund): 13% inc.
  - Estimated increase provided by CIS
  - Lower experience year dropped off
- Leave Liability (Payroll Reserve Fund): 3.5%
  - Increased from 2.5% due to Voluntary Resignation Program

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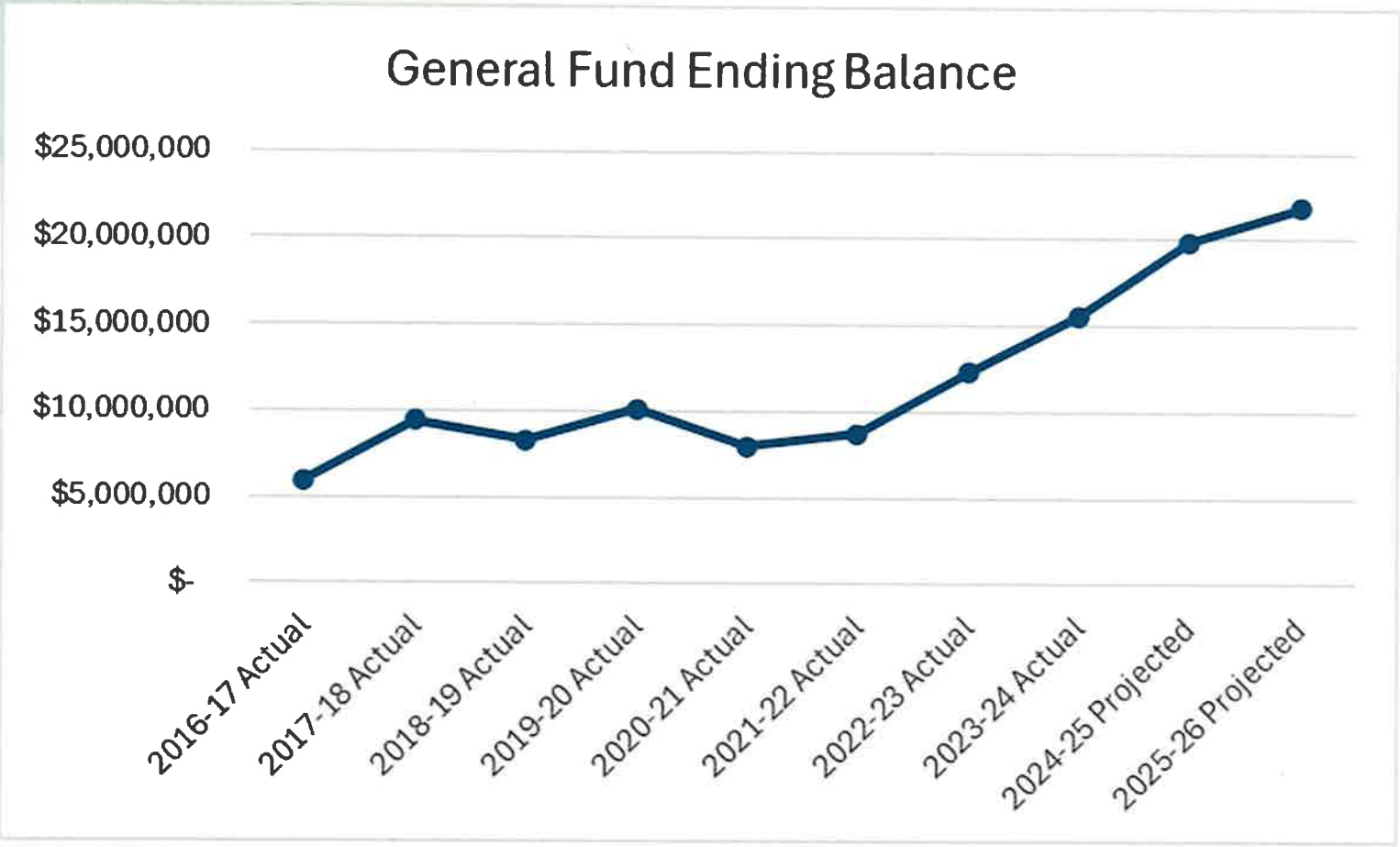
Advisory Rates

- Oregon Paid Leave:
  - Employer 0.4%
  - Employee 0.6%
- PERS rates 25/26 and 26/27:
  - PERS General Service 27.7%
  - PERS Police and Fire 34.6%
  - OPSRP General Service 25.5%
  - OPSRP Police and Fire 30.32%
- PERS Pickup: 6%
- PERS released advisory rates for fiscal years 2028 and 2029 and are expected to remain relatively flat

JOSEPHINE COUNTY


General Fund Ending Balance
$25,000,000
$20,000,000
$15,000,000
$10,000,000
$5,000,000
$-
2016-17 Actual
2017-18 Actual
2018-19 Actual
2019-20 Actual
2020-21 Actual
2021-22 Actual
2022-23 Actual
2023-24 Actual
2024-25 Projected
2025-26 Projected

General Fund Balance

- Contingency: 15% of operating expenses, approx. **$1.2 million**
  - For emergencies, such as a wildland fire
- Unappropriated Ending Fund Balance: approx. **$9.2 million**
  - Cash flow from July-November until taxes are collected
  - Cannot be touched in a supplemental budget
- Reserved for Future Expenditure: approx. **$10.9 million**
  - Remaining fund balance after Contingency and Unappropriated Ending Fund Balance
  - Could be more depending on SRS
  - Used to sustain Law Enforcement Fund for 5 years

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Allocation of Shared Resources

- General Fund
  - Status quo, new FTE requested during Budget Committee
  - Any exceptions? (example: Law Enforcement)
- Jail & Juvenile Detention Fund
  - Levy expires June 30, 2027
  - Status quo budgets will end the levy close to zero
- Animal Shelter & Control Fund
  - If no new levy, current levy expires June 30, 2027
  - Status quo budgets will end the levy close to zero

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Budget Goals

- Budget Goal #1 - Improve community outreach and communication to the public by increasing efficiencies within County Departments and providing enhanced service to citizens.

- Budget Goal #2 - Develop a sustainable plan for all mandated and essential County government programs.

- Budget Goal #3 - Provide access to County services to the citizens of Josephine County in a transparent, open and professional manner.

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Budget Calendar

- March 25th: Final budget workshop with BCC
  - Presentation of Reserve Funds (Property, Equipment, Forestry, Roads & Bridges)
  - Make final decisions listed on the next slide
- March 27th: Departments receive budget forms with rates and instructions
- April 17th: Department budgets are due to Finance
- May 19th: Budget Committee Meetings begin and continue for the next few weeks
- June 17th: Budget Hearing at WBS
- June 24th: Budget Adoption at WBS

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Decisions for Next Workshop

- Budget Goals
- General Fund Balance
  - Contingency: 15%, approx. $1.2 million
  - Unappropriated: cash flow until tax collection, approx. $9.2 million
  - Reserved for Future Exp: approx. $10.9 million, LE 5 yrs sustain.
- General Fund Allocation
  - Status quo, new FTE's requested during Budget Committee
  - Exceptions (for example: Law Enforcement)
- Rates
  - ISF (9.5%), Insurance (13% inc.), Leave Liability (3.5%), Facilities Operating ($0.90/sq ft) & Depreciation ($0.40/sq ft), Fleet as presented

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